

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

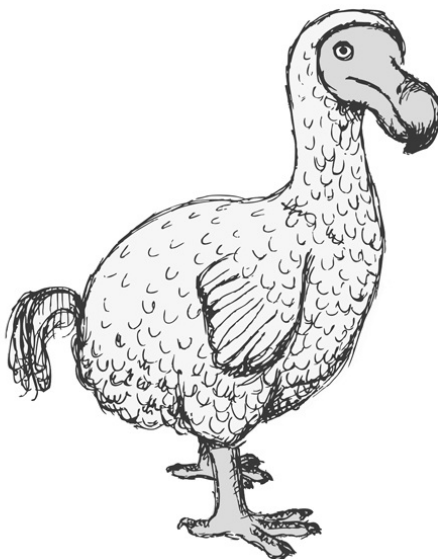
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: On the Path to Extinction



Learning Outcome

Describe environmental change in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Why do you believe animals become extinct?
- What are some ways to help protect animals and control declining populations?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about an environmental problem.
- I can write about things that are happening and things that have happened.
- I can write about cause and effect, and hypothetical situations.

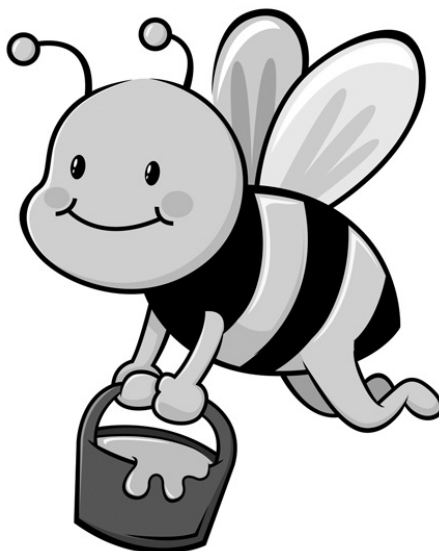




Let's Explore!

How much do we know about the smallest species living in our environments? Do we have a responsibility to all living **creatures***?

* A "creature" is an animal.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Experts are often asked by science forum writers whether the bumblebee is really in danger of becoming extinct. As an entomologist, I have been involved in this field of research for decades. I'm afraid that I must say yes, bee populations are under threat. One possible result of this is that the other species can become extinct when a food chain is disrupted by external forces.

The process that is leading to the extinction of the bumblebee is not completely clear. It may be due to the loss of their natural habitats and pesticides used by farmers against other insects that destroy their crops. The ideal habitat for the bumblebee is a field of natural wild flowers. However, most farming today involves large fields and farmers are often sticking to a single crop. If there are not enough plant varieties available, there is not enough nectar for the bees to survive. In addition, beekeepers think that some pesticides have caused bees to have trouble finding their way home ...

SOS ... bumblebee populations are being decimated by pesticides in some areas. There is somewhat of a problem with finding a solution to bee extinction. Some growers have tried to pollinate the fields themselves using helicopters and other equipment. Sometimes bees are given extra protein by growers to have enough energy to pollinate. However, these solutions are clearly not enough. If more research is not done into the processes involved in maintaining bee populations, we may have to kiss our sweet honey goodbye. The extinction of many species has been caused by a failure to act.





Let's Practice!

What happens if ...?

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. If an extinct species _____ for another organism, that organism _____ at risk for extinction.
 - a. has been food, would have become
 - b. had been food, would have become
 - c. is good, would have become
 - d. had been food, will become
2. If there _____ enough plant varieties available, there _____ enough nectar for bees to survive.
 - a. is not, are not
 - b. is not, is not
 - c. are not, are not
 - d. are not, is not
3. If more research _____ into the processes involved in maintaining bee populations, we _____ kiss our sweet honey goodbye.
 - a. is not done, may have to
 - b. are not done, may have to
 - c. will be done, may have to
 - d. isn't done, may not have to



Let's Practice!

What environmental issues are important to you? Let's find out!

Instructions: Write a 150-170 word paragraph on an environmental issue facing your country. It can be related to the loss of natural habitat for animals, deforestation, population, or a particular species that is under threat.

Answers Wh- questions.

Example: What is happening? Use paragraph structure (topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence).

Use conditional sentences starting with If ...

Remember: Include a variety of sentences (simple, compound, complex).





Extension Activity

Watch some trailers about bee movies.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch 4 trailers about different bee movies.
- What kinds of issues do they bring up in the movies? Write a summary of what you saw.
- Discuss the issue of declining bee populations with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch and reflect on 4 trailers about bees.

☐ ☐

I write a summary of the trailers.

☐ ☐

I discuss the issue of declining bee populations with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **entomologist** (noun): a scientist who studies and does research on insects
e.g. As an entomologist, I have been involved in this field of research for decades.
- **under threat** (expression): at risk of death or extinction
e.g. Bee populations are under threat.
- **habitat** (noun): the natural home of a plant or animal
e.g. Due to the loss of their natural habitats, bees are becoming extinct.
- **pesticide** (noun): a chemical substance used to kill insects and small animals that destroy crops
e.g. Pesticides are being used by farmers to protect their crops.
- **nectar** (noun): the sweet liquid that bees collect from flowers
e.g. There is not enough nectar for bees to survive.
- **to pollinate** (verb): to give a flower or plant pollen so that it can produce seeds
e.g. Some growers have tried to pollinate the fields themselves.
- **beekeeper** (noun): a person who is in charge of growing bees to make honey products
e.g. Beekeepers think that some pesticides have caused bees to have trouble finding their way home.
- **protein** (noun): one of several natural substances that exist in food used to build muscle and hair
e.g. Sometimes bees are given extra protein by growers.
- **extinction** (noun): when a particular type of animal or plant stops existing
e.g. The extinction of many species has been caused by a failure to act.





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences With *If*-Clauses

You use conditional sentences to describe the result of something that might happen or might have happened but didn't.

Zero conditional sentences have two **Present Simple** verbs, one in the ***if*-clause** and one in the **main clause**. You use this conditional when the result will always happen.

You use the form:

if + Present Simple, ... Present Simple

You use **first conditional** sentences to talk about things which might happen in the future.

You use the form:

if + Present Simple, ... *will* + infinitive

You can use **modals** (can, may, might) other than will in the main clause of a sentence in the first conditional.

You use the **second conditional** to talk about "unreal" or impossible events.

The **second conditional** uses the **Past Simple** after *if*, then "would" and the infinitive:

if + Past Simple, ... *would* + infinitive

You use the **third conditional** to talk about the past. It is used to describe a situation that didn't happen, and to imagine the result of this situation.

if + Past Perfect, ... *would* + *have* + past participle

Examples:

- *If more research is not done into the process of bee extinction, we may have to kiss our sweet honey goodbye.*
- *If an extinct species had been food for another organism, that organism would then have become at risk for extinction.*
- *If people had known of the negative impact of farming in sensitive areas, they would have considered other alternatives.*





Learning Points

Present Continuous / Present Perfect

You use the **Present Perfect** tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

The **Present Continuous** is used to talk about actions that are happening in the present moment but will soon finish.

You can also use these tenses in the passive form.

You use the **Present Continuous tense** when you talk about:

- things which are happening at the moment of speaking
- temporary situations
- temporary or new habits
- people in pictures and photos

For example:

*We **are living** in a changing world.*

*This process **is leading** to the extinction of the bumblebee.*

*Bumblebees **are being decimated** by pesticides. (passive)*

You can use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about experience.

When you use the **Present Perfect tense**, you think about the past and present together.

There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

*Some growers **have tried** to pollinate the fields themselves using helicopters and other equipment.*

*Bumblebee populations **have been destroyed** by human interest. (passive)*

*The extinction of many species **has been caused** by a failure to act. (passive)*

